

when it comes to caring for your kids. That creates bad Money Karma.

4. **Expensive baby toiletries.** If it was good enough for your mother to use on you, it's probably good enough for you to use on your baby. Stick to the simple stuff: baby oil, baby soap, and baby shampoo from the drugstore. Your baby does not need high-end skin care products. (By the way, *you* probably don't, either.)
5. **Fancy toys.** They clutter the house and spoil the kid. Lots of them are toxic hazards. Most kids, when given a choice between a multicolored, germ-infested activity center and a cardboard box filled with a bunch of Tupperware, will choose the Tupperware every time. We used to give my daughter, Savannah, old magazines to rip to shreds when she was a baby. When that bored her, emptying the contents of my wife's purse and filling it back up again would occupy her for a few more hours. (And my wife learned to keep the clutter in her purse to a minimum . . . and never to carry sharp objects or lipstick.)